Solipsism

Pavel Pavliv

What is solipsism?

solus (“alone”) + ipse (“self”)

(extreme) subjective idealism

Metaphysics

A person with a cup of hot tea

Where do all the external experiences come from?

Epistemology

The same example

Matrix?

Methodology

Limitations -> radicality

Ethics

Close to ethical egoism and nihilism

History

Gorgias

Was he serious about it?

History

Descartes

“I think, therefore I am”

History

Berkeley

“To be is to be perceived”

Methodological solipsism & individualism

Jerry Fodor

How to explain thinking and meaning?

Externalism

Putnam

Twin Earth

H2O vs XyZ

Problems with solipsism

Hard to disprove

Limited practical value

“As a serious conviction, on the other hand, it could only be found in a madhouse…”

Arthur Schopenhauer

Thank you for listening!